Sharing your learning experiences and support preferences

Practical guide for students | D16-ST

You can help your teacher understand what supports your learning by describing useful experiences, current barriers and specific requests. You can choose what personal information to share and use a private route when needed.

1. Identify what already helps

Think of a task you completed successfully. What helped: a worked example, clear steps, preparation time, a glossary or a chance to ask questions? Describe the practical feature rather than assigning yourself a fixed learning style.

2. Notice a specific barrier

Identify where access or understanding breaks down. For example, you may understand a calculation when reading it but lose track when steps are explained quickly without being shown.

3. Describe the experience

Use a concrete account: “When instructions are only spoken, I sometimes miss the final step.” You do not have to disclose your ethnicity, home language or personal history to describe a learning difficulty.

4. Suggest a practical change

Try: “Could the main steps also be written on the slide?” Explain how the change would help you complete the same task. Your teacher may suggest another workable option.

5. Choose how to communicate

Use an available survey, private conversation, consultation or written message. For sensitive information, ask which service or process is appropriate and who will have access to what you share.

6. Review what happens

Try the agreed approach and give specific feedback. If the difficulty continues, explain what remains hard and ask about further support. Some needs require a formal support pathway.

7. Example

You explain that a short preview of technical terms helps you follow a lecture. Your teacher shares key terms before the next lesson. Afterwards, you report which terms helped and ask about a concept you still could not follow. This gives the teacher useful information for the next step.

8. Quick checklist

☐ I can describe what helps me learn.

☐ I have identified a specific barrier.

☐ My request explains its learning purpose.

☐ I know how to follow up privately if needed.

9. When to seek further support

Ask the relevant support service about needs that require specialist advice or formal adjustments. You do not need to resolve these through classroom requests alone. Your teacher and institution also have responsibilities for accessible teaching and clear support routes.

10.Supporting sources

University of Minnesota, College of Continuing & Professional Studies. (n.d.). Tips for communicating with international and multilingual students. Open resource

Educator guidance supports checking understanding, inviting questions and discussing learning difficulties. Student self-advocacy steps are adaptations.

RMIT University Vietnam. (n.d.). Student Academic Success. Open resource

Illustrates academic advising, skill development and support pathways in Vietnamese higher education; availability and eligibility differ by institution.